

INVESTMENT MEMORANDUM

Theme: Alternative Credit & Payment Infrastructure in MENA's Emerging Private Sector

INVESTMENT RECOMMENDATION: BOKRA

Stage Seed to Series A	Cheque Size \$1.2M	Pre-Money Val. \$26.8M	Implied Stake 3-4%
Post-Money Val. \$32.8-33.8M	Projected Seed Round Size \$6-7M	Target Exit 2033-2034	Predicted Exit Route Strategic M&A (60%)

1. Why This Theme?

MENA is the fastest-growing fintech region globally¹, with a 35% growth rate doubling the global average, yet digital banking penetration sits at 17% compared with 60% in the US.² The fintech market reached \$169.92B in 2023³, and now accounts for 36% of all MENA venture funding and 29% of exits.⁴ Fintech solutions are proving scalable and successful, yet the infrastructure is not yet keeping up. That gap is where Dunes invests.

Why Now

- SMEs represent 96% of registered businesses yet receive just 8% of total bank lending, falling to 2% in the GCC.⁵
- There exists a structural inability for banks to price SME credit risk without alternative data pipelines. AI-native underwriting built on non-traditional data unlocks SME lending at scale for the first time. GCC governments committed over \$100B to AI in 2024 alone signalling an appetite to deploy AI in various industries.⁶
- Remittance Industry: over 38 million migrants live in the MENA region, accounting for more than 50% in the GCC and exceeding 85% in Qatar and the UAE, sending billions of dollars in remittances annually through expensive corridors.⁷
- Islamic finance is a key piece of the structural demand to MENA's Muslim majority population, valued at a \$3.96T global industry⁸ that is largely undigitized.
- Regulatory tailwinds: Active open banking sandboxes in Egypt, Saudi Arabia, and the UAE create multi-decade licensing moats.⁹
- MENA fintech funding surged 650% from 2020–23.¹⁰

2. Why Dunes Ventures?

Kanz Majdalawi brings 3 years of expertise in MENA investment advisory and public policy. Kanz studies History, Politics, and Economics at UCL and is currently a Principal Researcher at the London School of Economics. Prior to that, she worked as a Geopolitical Analyst at Azure Strategy, focusing on the MENA region, giving Dunes Ventures a differentiated diligence edge on the regulatory feasibility at the pre-investment stage.

Karim Abbas brings firsthand UAE banking experience at Standard Chartered Dubai in Treasury markets. Karim holds a bachelor's degree in Banking and a Master's in Private Equity, Venture Capital and Fintech from UCL, providing both the theoretical grounding and practical toolkit to evaluate early-stage financial infrastructure companies.

Our advisors are experts in the Fintech space in MENA: Peyman Mestchian (two-time fintech exit founder, former Head of Corporate Development at Quantexa), Maher Aoun (VP of Business Development at Wafeq/ Stanford alumnus) PMF; Omar Kamal, PhD (Co-founder B8 Venture Partners, former MENA bank CIO, early backer of Onfido

¹King & Spalding, MENA Fintech Report, April 2025. Net revenue CAGR 2023–2028.

²Fast Company Middle East, "MENA fintech market reached \$169.92B in 2023," 2024.

³World Bank Financial Inclusion Database, 2023; King & Spalding, 2025.

⁴King & Spalding, MENA Fintech Report, April 2025. Fintech share of MENA VC 2023–24.

⁵IFC MSME Finance Gap Report, 2022; GCC Central Bank aggregate data.

⁶Saudi Vision 2030 Fintech Strategy, 2023; UAE Central Bank Open Finance Framework, 2023.

⁷ILO and UN DESA Migration Data, 2023. GCC migrant population estimates.

⁸Global Islamic Fintech Report 2023/24. \$3.96T total Islamic finance assets.

⁹Saudi Central Bank (SAMA), Open Banking Framework, 2022; Central Bank of the UAE (CBUAE), Open Finance Policy, 2023; Financial Regulatory Authority of Egypt (FRA), Digital Onboarding Licence Framework, 2024.

¹⁰MAGNITT, MENA Venture Investment Report 2024.

and Threads) on embedded finance and portfolio construction; and Professor Fawaz A. Gerges (Emirates Chair, LSE) on geopolitical risk assessment.

9. Investment Recommendation

After evaluating 10 startups, we narrowed our focus to three firms for potential investments

	Bokra	Stream	SaturnX
Product	Goal-based wealth management via asset-backed securities, fractional investments for retail/SMEs in Egypt/	Automates B2B billing, invoicing, recurring payments/collections on local Saudi rails.	Stablecoin API infrastructure for B2B cross-border payments (Gulf-to-Asia corridors).
Funding Stage	Pre-seed (\$4.6M, 2024); additional \$58.9M in 2025 Africa roundup.	Seed (\$4M, Nov 2025; Outliers VC-led).	Seed (\$3M, Jun 2025; White Star-led).
Traction	App launched Q2 2024; Sharia-compliant upgrade Sep 2025; MENA expansion.	Founded 2024; 40% MoM growth; processes millions for thousands of users (schools/SaaS).	Founded 2024; \$250M+ volume in 5 months

Investment Recommendation: Bokra

Bokra is an Egyptian fintech providing savings tools, Sharia-compliant alternative credit, and digital payment infrastructure to SMEs and retail investors. We recommend a \$1.2M seed investment at a \$26.8M pre-money valuation, implying a 3.62% ownership stake. Our conviction is grounded in three facts: Bokra has executed a \$60M sukuk,¹¹ holds 16 FRA licences that competitors cannot quickly replicate,¹² and is addressing a \$46B structural financing gap¹³ with immediate demand.

Problem: The Egyptian pound has lost approximately 70% of its value against the dollar since 2022, amid four devaluations over 24 months.¹⁴ Annual inflation peaked at 36.5% in July 2023. EGP cash savings devalued instantly. Simultaneously, Egypt's \$46B annual SME financing gap, the product of a formal banking sector that cannot price SME credit risk without data infrastructure that does not exist, left 90% of businesses¹⁵ without access to formal credit. Bokra was built to solve both problems at once.

Solution: Bokra operates across two integrated verticals. First, their B2C platform offers inflation-proof savings: USD-linked and commodity-backed products that preserve real value against EGP devaluation, with no domestic equivalent. Second, their B2B platform offers alternative SME credit: Sharia-compliant sukuk issuance combined with AI-based alternative credit scoring, bridging the financing gap through regulatory- and culturally appropriate instruments for Egypt's Muslim-majority market.

Traction, GTM & Proof Points

Bokra is expanding rapidly, as evidenced by the issuance of \$60M in sukuks, demonstrating that Bokra can structure, register, and distribute Sharia-compliant instruments. The 16 FRA licences include a 2024 digital onboarding licence, enabling Bokra to offer, manage, and promote investment funds nationally. In Egypt's regulated environment, obtaining a licence is difficult, creating a durable competitive moat. They have 45,000 current users, highlighting wide-scale adoption¹⁶. Their short-term strategy has focused on poaching existing institutional banking customers by offering superior returns. They are expanding in Cairo & Alexandria via traditional marketing methods. They raised \$4.6M in pre-seed funding, led by DisrupTech Ventures (Egypt-based) and SS Capital (UAE-based),¹⁷ signalling strong regional investor conviction.

¹¹AGBI, "Egyptian fintech Bokra arranges \$60M sukuk," agbi.com, 2025.

¹²Bokra FRA lice disclosures, 2024. 16 licences including digital onboarding (2024).

¹³IFC MSME Finance Gap, Egypt country report, 2022. \$46B annual SME financing gap estimate.

¹⁴Central Bank of Egypt, Monetary Policy Reports, 2022–2024. Four EGP devaluation events cited

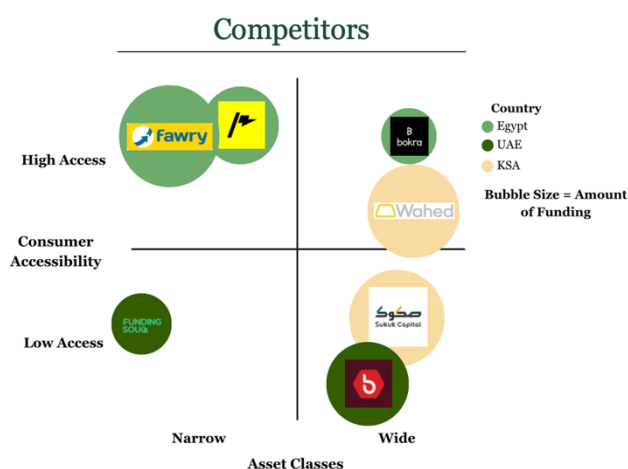
4. Market Analysis

TAM: USD 38.3B, (Egypt specific): \$3.3B SME credit gap+ \$35B retail savings/investment gap present

SAM: USD 3.8B, 9-10% of the gap is addressable via digital native solutions

SOM: USD 5.8M, Assuming 5% market capture in 3 years, with a blended take rate of 3%. \$5.8 million revenue capture

Competitive Landscape: Bokra is uniquely positioned in the Egyptian market, combining a wide range of asset classes with high consumer accessibility. Existing direct competitors like Thndr and Fawry predominantly offer access to Egyptian equities or low-yield savings accounts, while current domestic competitors do not focus on Sukuks (high yield savings), giving Bokra a market advantage.



Founding Team

The team brings over 120 combined years of fintech experience.

- **Ayman Elsawy (CEO & Co-Founder):** 21 years in non-bank finance and sukuk structuring across Egypt's regulated capital markets.
- **Samer Sallam (Co-Founder, Non-Executive):** Serial entrepreneur with a broad operational and strategic network across Egypt's private sector.
- **Mohamad Sallam (CBO):** Seasoned commercial executive with a track record in market scaling and institutional business development.
- **Mohamed Khadra (CMO):** Growth marketing specialist focused on digital acquisition and brand positioning in emerging fintech markets.

Current Risks & Mitigation

Risk	Level	Mitigation
Regulatory tightening (FRA enforcement shift on AI underwriting)	Medium	Compliance milestones tied to drawdown rights, not passive monitoring
Macro normalisation (EGP stabilisation weakens savings urgency)	Low–Medium	\$46B SME credit gap persists independently of currency dynamics
Adoption velocity (bank partnerships stall, CAC rises)	Medium	Two institutional partnerships in advanced stages; CAC milestone gated at Series A
Key-person risk (Ayman Elsawy: licences + regulatory relationships)	Medium	Key-person provisions, cliff vesting, and Dune's information rights in term sheet

Valuation Analysis & Terms

Bokra's value was determined using the VC method and score carding, guided by prior transactions and seed valuations in MENA. Their strong traction results in a pre-money valuation at \$26.8M and their post-money valuation between \$32.8M and \$33.8M, assuming a \$6-7M seed raise (aligns with median comparables). Our term sheet includes valuation cap conversion at a discount, 1x liquidation preference for investors, broad-based weighted average anti-dilution, and board/governance rights.

Why could we be wrong?

Regulatory retrenchment. If the FRA tightens data compliance enforcement before Bokra achieves scale, the cost of compliance could compress margins faster than revenue growth.

Scalability. There is yet to be a Fintech in the MENA region able to scale across borders. Bokra may be limited by its geography, its inability to comply with foreign regulators, and a lack of data in other countries.



Macro normalisation. If EGP stabilises and inflation returns to single digits, the urgency of inflation-proof savings weakens. Bokra is still in its early stages, and consumer stickiness remains an open question. Furthermore, the liquidity of the Sukuks they are issuing is also a pertinent question.

We recommend investing in Bokra with a projected commitment of USD 1-1.2M, targeting a 3-4% equity stake, subject to further discussions and access to the data room as part of enhanced due diligence.

Information sourced directly from interviews and
material from Bokra